KHAKI BLUES

Tasked with maintaining law and order, the police's difficult role has been rendered tougher due to political interference and neglect of reform

By Kaushik Deka



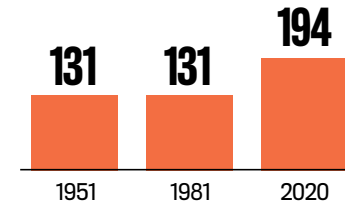
PRIDE IN UNIFORM
A young policeman in Calcutta in the mid-1950s

GETTY IMAGES

NOT AN IDEAL COUNT

The expenditure on police may have increased in absolute terms, but a meagre amount is spent on police modernisation. The police-population ratio remains below the globally recommended standard

POLICE PER 100,000 POPULATION



222
NUMBER OF POLICE PERSONNEL RECOMMENDED BY THE UNITED NATIONS FOR EVERY 100,000 POPULATION

EXPENDITURE ON POLICE BY CENTRE AND THE STATES

₹59 crore 1951

₹2.36 lakh crore 2021

MODERNISATION OF POLICE

Central government's assistance to states for modernisation of police — ₹2,057 CR. (2.2%*)

State government's expenditure — ₹1,476 CR. (1.21%*)

*Share of total expenditure on police

562,328
OR 21 PER CENT POSTS LYING VACANT IN POLICE FORCES ACROSS INDIA AGAINST A SANCTIONED STRENGTH OF 2,631,890